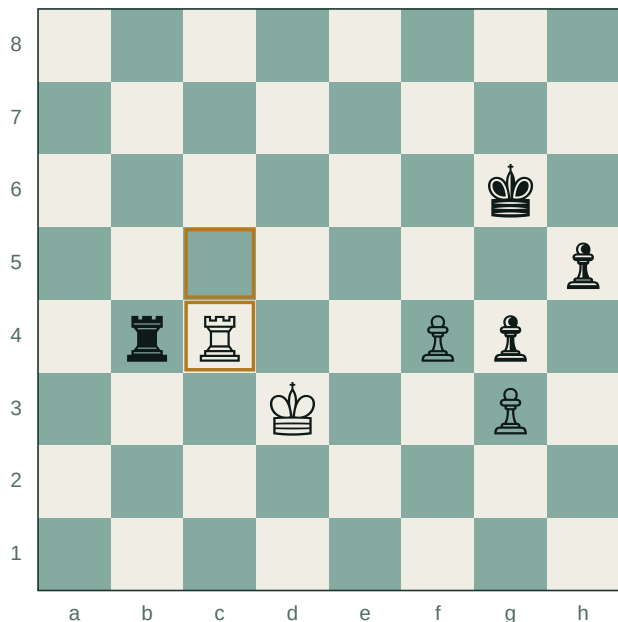


Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 56

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 56.Rc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

56...Rxc4 57. Kxc4 h4 58. gxh4 g3

56...Rxc4 The rook captures the rook on c4. Recorded reply: **57.Kxc4**.

57...h4 The pawn moves from h5 to h4. Recorded reply: **58.gxh4**.

58...g3 The pawn moves from g4 to g3.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from +0 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on d3. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.